

39) Find the dual of each of these compound propositions

a) $p \wedge q \wedge r$ Dual: $p \vee q \vee r$

b) $(p \wedge r) \vee s$ Dual: $(p \vee r) \wedge s$

c) $(p \vee F) \wedge (q \vee T)$ Dual: $(p \wedge T) \vee (q \wedge F)$

41) Show that $(S^*)^* = S$ when S is a compound proposition.

Soln: The proof will be by strong mathematical induction on n , which is the number of $\wedge$ and $\vee$ present in a compound proposition S .

Base Case: $n=0$. $\because S$ is an atomic proposition by defn.

The truth value of S is either True or False. Let, wlog it be True.

$\therefore (S^*)$ has a truth value of False (by defn. of dual)

$\therefore (S^*)^*$ has a truth value of True (by defn. of dual)

So $(S^*)^* = S$ in this situation. We can prove similarly that $(S^*)^* = S$ when the truth value of S is False.

Induction Hypothesis: $n=k$. For all compound propositions S having no. of logical operators ($\wedge$ or $\vee$) $\leq k$, $(S^*)^* = S$.

Induction Step: $n=k+1$. The compound proposition S can be written in one of the following ways ① $S = p \wedge q$ OR ② $S = p \vee q$, where both p, q has $\leq k$ propositional logical operators ($\wedge$ or $\vee$), o.w. S would have more than $(k+1)$ logical operators.

Case 1: $S = p \wedge q$. $\therefore S^* = p^* \vee q^*$ (Follows from the defn. of dual)
 $(S^*)^* = (p^*)^* \wedge (q^*)^*$ (Follows from the defn. of dual)
 $= p \wedge q$ (From Induction Hypothesis)
 $= S$

Case 2: $S = p \vee q$. $\therefore S^* = p^* \wedge q^*$ (Follows from the defn. of dual)
 $(S^*)^* = (p^*)^* \vee (q^*)^*$ (Follows from the defn. of dual)
 $= p \vee q$ (From Induction Hypothesis)
 $= S$

$\therefore (S^*)^* = S \quad \square$